

RRB NTPC Advanced Practice Paper

Ancient Indian History — Comprehensive Syllabus Set 2 (10 High-Yield Questions)

1. The unique dockyard facility found at the Harappan site of Lothal was linked to the ancient waters of which river channel?

- A) Bhogavo
- B) Ghaggar
- C) Ravi
- D) Hindon

Correct Answer: A) Bhogavo

Detailed Explanation: Lothal is located near the Gulf of Khambhat on the banks of the Bhogavo River, a tributary of the Sabarmati, enabling maritime commerce.

2. The foundational macro-geographical layout of ancient India is described in the Puranas using the term 'Jambudvipa'. Which specific mountain range was considered the central axis or pivot of the universe in this cosmic layout?

- A) Himavat
- B) Mount Meru
- C) Vindhya
- D) Nisadha

Correct Answer: B) Mount Meru

Detailed Explanation: Puranic geography visualizes Jambudvipa centered around the golden Mount Meru, with Bharatavarsha located to its south.

3. The ancient text 'Milindapanha' records conversations between Indo-Greek king Menander and Nagasena. In which ancient capital city, famous as a center of culture and trade, did these dialogues take place?

- A) Pataliputra
- B) Sakala (Sialkot)
- C) Taxila
- D) Mathura

Correct Answer: B) Sakala (Sialkot)

Detailed Explanation: Sakala was Menander's capital city and serves as the urban backdrop for his profound philosophical exchanges with Sage Nagasena.

4. The architectural design of the Kailasanatha Temple at Ellora (Cave 16) is a structural wonder carved entirely from a monolithic rock cliff. Which Rashtrakuta monarch commissioned this monumental work?

- A) Dantidurga
- B) Krishna I
- C) Amoghavarsha
- D) Govinda III

Correct Answer: B) Krishna I

Detailed Explanation: King Krishna I (756–774 CE) directed the excavation of the spectacular rock-cut Kailasa temple, showcasing complex Dravidian architectural features.

5. Kautilya's Saptanga theory of state lists seven structural pillars. Which of the following is defined as the 'ears' of the kingdom, representing allies and diplomats?

- A) Mitra
- B) Kosha
- C) Danda
- D) Amatya

Correct Answer: A) Mitra

Detailed Explanation: The Saptanga elements are: Swami (head), Amatya (eyes), Janapada (legs), Durga (fort/arms), Kosha (mouth), Danda (mind/army), and Mitra (ears/allies).

6. During the Gupta period, the unique tax known as 'Udranga' was explicitly collected from which source or category of citizens?

- A) Temporary tenants
- B) Permanent peasants/landholders
- C) Artisans and weavers
- D) Maritime merchants

Correct Answer: B) Permanent peasants/landholders

Detailed Explanation: Udranga was a land tax levied on permanent tenants, whereas Uparikara was imposed on temporary or migratory cultivators.

7. The ancient seat of learning, Nalanda University, was protected and financially sustained by many kings. Who was the Pala ruler who founded Vikramashila University as a rival center of Buddhist studies?

- A) Gopala
- B) Dharmapala
- C) Devapala
- D) Mahipala

Correct Answer: B) Dharmapala

Detailed Explanation: Dharmapala founded the Vikramashila monastery in the late 8th century CE to revive and structure specialized Vajrayana Buddhist education.

8. In the structural classification of early Tamil Sangam landscape, which ecological zone ('Tinais') corresponded directly to arid, desert-like terrains or dry parched tracts?

- A) Kurinji
- B) Palai
- C) Mullai
- D) Marutam

Correct Answer: B) Palai

Detailed Explanation: The five Tinais are Kurinji (hilly), Mullai (pastoral), Marutam (agricultural), Neithal (coastal), and Palai (arid/desert).

9. The historical composition 'Gathasaptashati', an anthology of Prakrit love poems, is attributed to a king belonging to which major ancient southern dynasty?

- A) Satavahana
- B) Ikshvaku
- C) Vakataka
- D) Kadamba

Correct Answer: A) Satavahana

Detailed Explanation: King Hala of the Satavahana dynasty compiled the Gathasaptashati (Sattasai) in Maharashtri Prakrit, highlighting the rich vernacular literary traditions.

10. The fundamental structural split in Jainism leading to Svetambaras and Digambaras was precipitated by a severe famine in Magadha. Which monk led the migrating group to Shravanabelagola in the south?

- A) Sthulabhadra
- B) Bhadrabahu
- C) Jambuswami
- D) Sudharman

Correct Answer: B) Bhadrabahu

Detailed Explanation: Bhadrabahu led the orthodox group to Karnataka during the famine, preserving the strict vows of nudity (Digambara), while Sthulabhadra stayed north (Svetambara).